Taiwo Oyedele (oy-eh-DEH-leh)

Minister of Finance and Coordinating Minister of the Economy of Nigeria

Addressed as: **Honorable Minister** | Office held since: **April 2026**

Taiwo Oyedele is a technocratic reformer whose successful redesign of Nigeria's tax code has earned him a promotion as the country's new economic lead.

- **The Star Performer**
  Oyedele, who has spent his career mastering the intricacies of tax policy and fiscal reform, ushered through several landmark tax bills, resulting in two ministerial promotions within seven weeks.

- **The Moral Crusader**
  Oyedele is a staunch believer in his work, stating that "we will not compromise the future of the country to protect those who have profited for years without paying taxes." His conviction comes through in his combative social media posts.

Oyedele's relative lack of political experience, in contrast to his immediate predecessor, has raised concerns about his ability to navigate the political pressures associated with his new role.

WHY THEY MATTER

Oyedele is responsible for deepening the country's economic reforms in the face of sustained public discontent and heightened political pressures ahead of President Bola Tinubu's reelection campaign in 2027.

- **The Hard Sell**
  Oyedele wants to increase revenue generation to meet the state's rising public demands without worsening the country's fiscal instability. It is a challenging task as the IMF cuts Nigeria's 2026 growth rate forecast to 4.1 percent from 4.4 percent.

- **The Business Solution**
  Oyedele is a proponent of working with the private sector to finance sustainable development. He has championed ease-of-doing business reforms and revenue modernization. He argues that technology and better systems can improve productivity.

While his reform agenda is business-friendly on paper, Oyedele inherits an economy where inflation remains stubborn, the naira continues to swing, and Nigerians are angry about the cost of living. Nigeria's political calendar, chiefly mounting pressure to lavish government funds on certain constituencies, presents a major obstacle to his objectives.

DRAGO

MEETING WITH THEM

Oyedele is remarkably accessible, using everyday examples to find common ground with counterparts and taking to social media to engage the public. His tendency to wade into contentious topics, however, often courts controversy.

- **The Personal Touch**
  Oyedele can code-switch between the formal and informal, but he is most effective when he tells his story. In one exchange, he introduced himself as “Taiwo. I'm from Makoko…indeed I'm 100% Nigerian. I went to a primary school in the village…the local authority school that I went to and of course that meant local government was financing it at that time and it was free."

- **The Shared Experience**
  The Minister talks a lot about being Nigerian. He reminds audiences that “at the end of the day, we all want a country we can be proud of.” On morning TV and podcasts he uses Yoruba-inflected phrasing, Pidgin markers, laughs audibly, teases interviewers, and drops in local humor.

Oyedele, at times, can come across as impatient and defensive about his reforms. He has been known to challenge critics directly on social media, posting rebuttals, accusing journalists of misquoting him, and fact-checking coverage in real time.

ON THEIR MIND

- **Rising Inflation from Iran Conflict**
  The Nigerian National Bureau of Statistics indicated that both headline and food inflation in March rose to 15.38 percent and 14.31 percent. The surge comes amid 50 percent and 70 percent increase in fuel and automotive gas oil prices, respectively, since the conflict broke out in February.

- **Nigeria to Cut Import Duties on Food, Vehicles**
  Nigeria plans to slash import duties on food, vehicles and industrial inputs to rein in inflation and ease rising living costs starting on July 1. The cuts will include sharp tariff reductions on rice, sugar, palm oil, passenger vehicles and construction materials.

- **Road Construction Loans**
  Tinubu in late April asked the Senate to approve a proposal to borrow $516.3 million from Deutsche Bank AG to finance the construction of the Sokoto–Badagry superhighway.

- **U.S. Travel Warning**
  The U.S. government in early April urged its citizens to reconsider traveling to Nigeria, citing risks such as terrorism, civil unrest and kidnapping. It also authorized the departure of "non-emergency" U.S. staff and their families.

DRAGO

NETWORK

Oyedele's international profile is consistent with his technocratic background, but he doesn't restrain himself from criticizing U.S. trade policies and Chinese extractive practices.

Throughout his professional career, Oyedele has built relationships with governments and businesses across 30 African countries. Nonetheless, he speaks his mind when it comes to global powers. He argues that Nigeria needs to reduce its dependency on the United States and prevent China and other countries from exploiting its mineral wealth.

Oyedele does not appear to be close to Tinubu, although his boldness and record of achievement have impressed the Nigerian president.

Oyedele doesn't have his predecessor's decades of friendship with Tinubu, but there is a budding admiration between the two men. Following Oyedele's swearing in, Tinubu remarked that "we are very proud of your knowledge, your simplicity, ambition, and excellence."

CONTROVERSIES

Oyedele has no personal scandals, but he has had to recover from early missteps in his official capacity and contend with death threats.

- **Conflict of Interest**
  Shortly after his appointment to lead the Presidential Committee on Fiscal Policy and Tax Reforms, Oyedele faced public criticism regarding his dual role as government reformer and PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC) executive. He subsequently resigned from PwC to "prevent any potential distractions."

- **Altered Taxes**
  A House of Representatives member alleged that the published tax laws differ from what legislators approved — including changed thresholds and omitted provisions. Oyedele admitted to "manual errors" and suggested a legislative fix.

Oyedele has claimed that he received death threats from his opponents who have long benefited from tax evasion. It forced him to move his family to a secure location while his wife kept vigil at night on his behalf.

DRAGO

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **Minister of Finance & Coordinating Minister of the Economy**, Government of Nigeria (2026 - present)
- **Minister of State for Finance**, Government of Nigeria (2026)
- **Chairman**, Presidential Committee on Fiscal Policy and Tax Reforms (2023 to 2026)
- **Fiscal Policy Partner and Africa Tax Leader**, PricewaterhouseCoopers (2021 to 2026)
- **Partner**, PricewaterhouseCoopers (2009 to 2021)
- **Various Roles**, PricewaterhouseCoopers (2001 to 2009)

BIO

Oyedele's rise from a rural village in Ondo State to Nigeria's most powerful economic post reflects his indefatigable work ethic. Born June 18, 1975, in Ikaram, Akoko, in Ondo State, he grew up the son of a retired school headmaster who instilled a love of education and professional approach to policy.

- **A Striver**
  As a student, Oyedele spent his weekends clearing bush for farmers to cover his school fees. In a widely told story, Oyedele reportedly sold his hostel bed to fund his professional exams and become a chartered accountant.

- **An Achiever**
  Joining PwC in 2001, Oyedele became a partner in just eight years. He is a professor at Babcock University and holds academic appointments at the University of Lagos and Lagos Business School. He is also a prolific writer, publishing books and articles, as well as regular columns titled "Tax Bites" in *BusinessDay* and "Tax Watch" in *The Guardian.*

Oyedele is married with two children. His name, Taiwo, is the default name given to the first-born twin in Yoruba tradition — paired with Kehinde for the second. The Minister, who speaks English and Yoruba, is part of his church's professional leadership circle and often talks about his faith.